Santiago Saldivar

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Education

Fordham University — Bronx, NY
B.S. in Information Systems — *Graduated: Spring 2023*

Suffolk County Community College — Riverhead, NY
A.S. in Accounting | Norman R. McConney, Jr. Award Recipient — *Graduated: Spring 2020*

Experience

IT Senior Audit Analyst — Innovation Team — Oct. 2025 – Present
Fidelity Investments — *Jersey City, NJ*

- Built a secure **AI-powered chat interface** enabling users to submit and parse sensitive company data, using **Next.js, TypeScript, and React** with a **FastAPI** backend, **Oracle DB**, and **Redis** for caching and session management.
- Spearheaded a legacy frontend migration, consolidating two applications into a unified platform via dynamic page rendering, cutting the codebase from 9,000 to 3,000 lines (**67% reduction**) and reducing AI token usage.
- Implemented **role-based access control** using **Better-Auth**, managing user sessions and granting permission-specific tool access to enforce data security policies across the platform.
- Engineered a **Dockerized** development environment with hot-reloading and created a multi-stage Dockerfile that reduced image size by **12% (4.3GB to 3.8GB)**, improving build times and streamlining team workflows.
- Mentored **3 team members** in Docker workflows and frontend development best practices, becoming a go-to technical reference across the innovation team for troubleshooting, code reviews, and architectural decisions.

Founder / Digital Operations Consultant — Apr. 2025 – Present
Varsa Studios — *Wainscott, NY*

- Founded a tech marketing firm advising **14+ clients** on automation, web development, and marketing strategy.
- Grew team capacity by onboarding and mentoring **2 new interns**, teaching authentication implementation and code architecture best practices.
- Cut recurring hosting costs by **$80/month** by migrating a client site off Webflow and containerizing it for deployment on self-managed cloud infrastructure.

Software Engineer — Jan. 2022 – Oct. 2025
Gov Glance Foundation — *Remote*

- Reduced crawler development time from 3 hours to 2 minutes (**99% time savings**) by engineering a universal heuristic spider that adapts to diverse website structures, eliminating manual crawler development and reducing reliance on costly AI APIs, cutting operational costs.
- Mentored **3+ team members and 1 intern** to a **100% job placement success rate** by leading data sourcing development initiatives and teaching data modeling best practices, resulting in an intern securing a full-time Software Engineering position.
- Reduced query time by **80%**, from 5 seconds to 1 second, by redesigning database architecture and implementing metadata indexing to enable real-time query capabilities across large-scale datasets.
- Developed an intelligent **URL classification system** achieving **96% accuracy** in filtering genuine article pages from large datasets by implementing a weighted scoring algorithm with regex pattern matching and heuristic analysis.
- Improved data consistency across government sources by **90%** by developing **ETL pipelines** that validate, cleanse, and transform raw data into standardized models, while overseeing four isolated cloud environments with dedicated IAM roles and CI/CD workflows.

Assistant Project Manager / Lineman — Jan. 2022 – Mar. 2023
Sound Aircraft Services — *East Hampton, NY*

- Serviced a wide range of private and commercial aircraft, including fueling, pumping fuel trucks for contamination and water testing, marshaling/parking aircraft, and handling passenger luggage, while maintaining strict **safety and compliance standards**.
- Conducted meetings with the **CFO** on the development of **FlightTalker**, contributing to design discussions and communicating stakeholder objectives to the offshore development team in India.

- Managed software project tasks by creating **JIRA** tickets for bug fixes and feature enhancements, ensuring comprehensive tracking and resolution.
- Identified **vulnerabilities** in the Google Maps API key, proactively addressing security risks and ensuring proper key restrictions.

DevOps Intern Jun. 2021 – Aug. 2021
Mediaocean *New York, NY (Remote)*

- Developed a **webhook integration** combining **Bitbucket** pull requests to notify the assigned reviewers and their respective teams over **Microsoft Teams**, using a Python script, a **Jenkins** job, the Bitbucket API, and the Teams webhook API.

Projects

Ánimo Run Club | *Shopify Hydrogen, TypeScript, Cloudflare Workers, React Router* 2025

- Shipped a production headless e-commerce storefront from zero to live in **2 weeks** using **Shopify Hydrogen** and Storefront GraphQL API, integrating **Cloudflare Stream**, Turnstile bot protection, and Resend for transactional email — deployed to the edge via **Cloudflare Workers**.

Pitaya New York | *Medusa.js, Next.js, PostgreSQL, Redis, Docker, Coolify* 2025

- Built and deployed a full-stack e-commerce platform using **Medusa.js** and **Next.js**, containerized across **4 services** with **Docker Compose** orchestration and a CI/CD pipeline via Coolify.
- Maintained production stability under strict constraints (**2 vCPUs, 4GB RAM**) via per-container resource limits, custom PostgreSQL tuning, and Redis LRU eviction policies.

Things to Do in The Hamptons | *Next.js, Supabase, AI Parsing* Apr. 2025 – Present

- Built and launched a local event discovery platform reaching **1,200+ users** in 3+ months with a **138% monthly growth rate** by identifying a gap in existing platforms (including Eventbrite) that failed to capture niche local events.
- Deployed **phi3:mini LLM** on **NVIDIA Jetson Orin Nano** for temporal extraction, implementing a three-tier fallback (regex → sparse processing → LLM chunking) within **8GB unified memory** constraints.

LocalThings.io | *Next.js, TypeScript, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Apple Maps* 2025 – Present

- Building LocalThings.io, the next-generation successor to Things to Do in The Hamptons, using a **Next.js/TypeScript** frontend backed by a **FastAPI** server and **PostgreSQL** database.
- Reduced geocoding costs by replacing Google's Address API with **OpenAddresses.io**, enabling faster address lookups at crawler scale while eliminating per-query API fees.
- Developing an **address-normalization pipeline** to reconcile user-submitted event addresses against OpenAddresses.io geodata, improving plotting accuracy on Apple Maps.
- Refining heuristic spiders to improve aggregation of niche local events, while mentoring an intern on the crawler development process.

Government Metasearch Engine | *SearXNG, Django, MongoDB, NGINX*

- github.com/govglancefoundation/supersift
- Customized **UI/UX** and backend of **SearXNG** to unify search across government datasets.
- Improved frontend performance and added **API integration** with scraped sources.

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, PostgreSQL, GraphQL, JavaScript (TypeScript), MQL, Bash, HTML/CSS
Frameworks/Libraries: React, Next.js, Remix, Flask, Django, LangChain, FastAPI, Tailwind, Supabase, Better-Auth
Tools & Platforms: Git, Bitbucket, DigitalOcean, Oracle DB, Neo4j, MongoDB, Vercel, Cloudflare Workers, NGINX, JIRA, Jenkins, Docker, Shopify Hydrogen, Vite, Figma
AI/ML & Edge Computing: scikit-learn, SpaCy, OpenCV, Tesseract, Ollama, Quantized LLMs, NVIDIA Jetson, CUDA, ARM64
Web Crawling: Scrapy, BeautifulSoup, Requests, AsyncIO, Trafilatura
Other: CI/CD, SEO, Server-Side Rendering (SSR), Edge AI deployment, Redis, PDF parsing